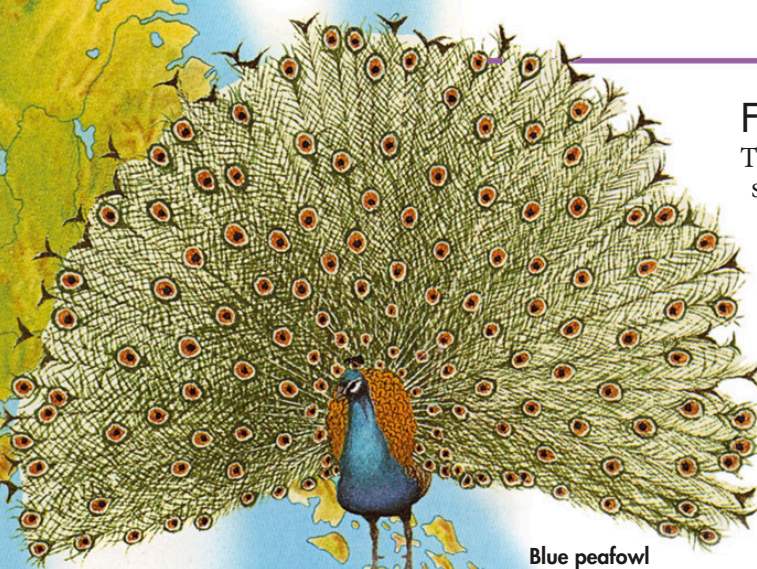


The woodlands of northern India are home to many animals and birds.



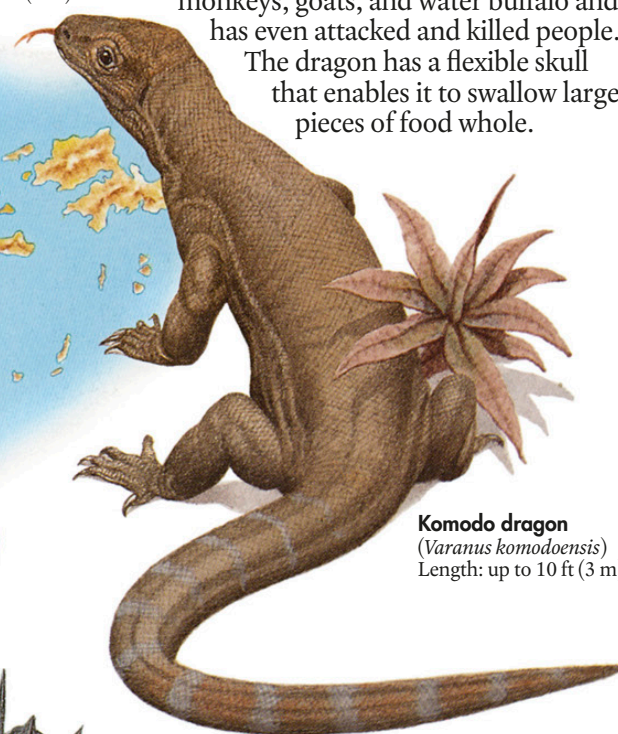
Blue peafowl
(*Pavo cristatus*)
Body length:
up to 7 ft 6 in (2.3 m)
Tail: up to 3 ft 3 in (1 m)

Feather fan

The male blue peafowl, known as a peacock, spreads out his long feathers in an enormous fan to attract a peahen. The huge staring "eyes" on his feathers may help hypnotize the peahen and allow the male to mate with her. In the breeding season, the male defends his territory against other males. Fights can last a day or more, but the birds rarely injure each other. When the mating season ends, the male's plumes fall out.

Giant dragon

The rare Komodo dragon is the largest lizard in the world. It feeds on small deer, monkeys, goats, and water buffalo and has even attacked and killed people. The dragon has a flexible skull that enables it to swallow large pieces of food whole.



Komodo dragon
(*Varanus komodoensis*)
Length: up to 10 ft (3 m)

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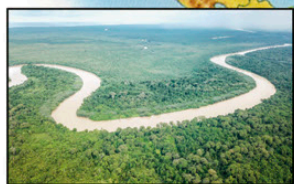
Salween

KITTI'S
HOG-NOSED
BAT

S O U T H E A S T E R N A S I A



Mangrove swamps grow along the coasts of India and many of the islands of southeastern Asia.

ATLAS
MOTHMALAYAN
TAPIR

Aerial view of rainforest on the island of Borneo.

GOLD-SPOTTED
MUDSKIPPERPROBOSCIS
MONKEYBORNEAN
ORANGUTANSUNDA
COLUGO

SULAWESI

KOMODO DRAGON

Skin wings

The colugo, or flying lemur, glides from one rainforest tree to another using thin "wings" of skin that stretch between its arms, legs, and tail. The colugo climbs awkwardly because its folded wings get in the way. On the ground, it is helpless and cannot even stand up. A young colugo clings to its mother's belly as she glides.



Sunda colugo
(*Galeopterus variegatus*)
Body: up to 16.5 in (42 cm)
Tail: up to 11 in (28 cm)

Kitti's hog-nosed bat
(*Craseonycteris thonglongyai*)
Wingspan: up to 6.7 in (17 cm)



Smallest mammal

Along with the Etruscan shrew, the tiny Kitti's hog-nosed bat is the smallest mammal in the world. It is sometimes called the "bumblebee bat" because it is no bigger than a bee. Kitti's hog-nosed bat is very rare and lives only in a few isolated caves in the rainforests of Thailand. Its piglike nose may help it snatch insects and other invertebrates from the surface of leaves.

Walking fish

The mudskipper uses its fleshy fins like arms to pull itself over the mud of the mangrove swamps. When the tide rises, the mudskipper climbs up a tree and clings to the branches using a "sucker" made from two of its rear fins joined together.



Gold-spotted mudskipper
(*Periophthalmus chrysopilus*)
Length: up to 5 in (13 cm)

Proboscis monkey
(*Nasalis larvatus*)
Length: up to
2 ft 6 in (76 cm)
Tail: up to
2 ft 2 in (67 cm)



Loudspeaker nose

The male proboscis monkey has a large nose, which gets in the way when he eats. This nose probably acts as a loudspeaker for the male's honking calls, which warn others of danger. The nose straightens out during each honk and swells or turns red if the monkey gets angry or excited. The proboscis monkey is very agile, leaping through the mangrove forests using its long tail for balance.

Swinging arms

The orangutan has long, muscular arms which it uses to swing rapidly through the trees. On the ground, the orangutan stands upright or walks on all fours. At night, it sleeps in a tree, in a nest made of sticks. The name orangutan means "jungle man" in the Malay language.



Bornean orangutan
(*Pongo pygmaeus*)
Body: up to
3 ft 2 in (97 cm)